UNIVERSITY AT ALBANY
State University of New York

College of Arts and Sciences
Department of Mathematics and Statistics

Algebra/Topology Seminar

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Vector Fields on Chain Complexes, and How to Triangulate a Prism

Thursday, October 29, 2026
3:00 p.m. in Massry B008

Abstract. We will discuss the notion of a vector field on a chain complex, and how that relates to the classical notion of a vector field on a smooth manifold. This leads to the somewhat surprising and fun fact that among all the possible ways to triangulate the prism $\Delta^n \times I$ (where Δ^n is the standard n-simplex and I is the unit interval), there is exactly one triangulation that is more equal than the others. This talk will be very accessible to graduate students.